



P15 · 12 PAGES, PRINTABLE + DOOR SIGN

The Visitor Welcome Packet

Twelve printable pages for the people you do want to come over. A door sign, three ground rules, a "how to help without being told" list, a food-drop menu, and a one-page kitchen orientation so you don't have to teach anyone where the silverware is. Pairs with the Saying No Script Pack.

Soothemade **Notes**

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A note before you print

The Saying No Script Pack is for the people who shouldn't come yet. This is the opposite document. It is for your sister, your best friend, the neighbor you trust, your mother if your mother is one of the helpful ones. The people whose presence in your house will make the first six weeks easier and not harder.

The trouble with these people is not that they aren't welcome. It is that they often want to help in ways that require you, the depleted person, to teach them. They ask "what can I do?" twelve times. They open the fridge looking for cups. They wait in the doorway because they do not want to overstep.

This packet does the teaching part ahead of time. You print it once, in week 35 of pregnancy. You leave it where the front door meets the kitchen. You point at it when someone arrives.

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How to use this packet

In the third trimester, with your partner if you have one, do these things in order:

1. **Print the packet.** All twelve pages. Cardstock if you have it, regular paper if you don't.
2. **Fill in the blanks.** There aren't many. Names, the few "yes" and "no" choices, your dog's name, your wifi password (we'll get to that).
3. **Hang the door sign on a hook by the front door.** Two versions are in the packet, one cream side and one sage side. Pick which way you want it to default to.
4. **Tape the kitchen orientation page to the inside of a kitchen cabinet door.** People will find it when they go looking for a cup.
5. **Tape the food-drop menu to the fridge.** Outside, not inside.
6. **Keep the visit log on the counter.** Anyone who comes signs and notes what they brought. It will be invaluable later.

That's the setup. It is a 20-minute project. It buys you 200 minutes of not-explaining over the first six weeks.

Page one, the door sign

The door sign hangs on a hook outside the front door. It flips depending on what's happening inside.

Side A, “we are awake”

We are awake.

Come in. The kitchen is yours.
The baby is meeting visitors.

Two hours, two people max.
Please wash hands.
No kissing the baby.

If you came with a cough, fever, or cold
in the last 72 hours: please come back later.

With love,

_____ + _____

Side B, “we are resting”

We are resting.

Please do not ring.

Please do not knock.

If you have brought food, please leave it
on the porch. We will text you a thank-you
when we surface.

If you are family and worried, the baby
is fine. We are fine. We are sleeping.

With love,

_____ + _____

Flip it as the day changes. There is no schedule. The version of the sign that is showing is the truth in that moment.

Page two, the three ground rules

A single sheet on the kitchen counter. Three rules, no more. Anything more than three is a treatise no one will read.

Three small things while you're here:

1. Wash your hands when you come in.
The soap is by the sink.
2. No kissing the baby.
Even on the top of the head. Even on the foot.
Hugs and held-hands are great.
3. If you came with a cough, fever, sore throat,
or runny nose in the last three days,
please come back when you are well.

With love,

_____ + _____

Space at the bottom for your own additions, if you have a few that matter to you. ("Please leave shoes by the door." "Please use the guest bathroom, not the main one.") Don't over-add. Three is the cap.

Page three, how to help without being told

This is the page everyone will appreciate, including you. It hangs on the front of the fridge. Or it gets handed to the person who keeps asking "what can I do?"

Twelve things you can do, right now,
without asking us:

- ☐ Take out the trash (bag refills are under the sink)
- ☐ Empty the dishwasher (we use the matching mugs daily)
- ☐ Load the dishwasher (rinse first, please)
- ☐ Wipe down the kitchen counters
- ☐ Walk the dog (_____ , leash by the door)
- ☐ Refill the water glass on the bedside table
- ☐ Refill the snack basket on the nursing chair
- ☐ Fold the laundry that is on the chair
- ☐ Take a load of laundry to the washer or dryer
- ☐ Sweep the front hall (broom in the pantry)
- ☐ Restock the diaper changing station
- ☐ Make a coffee or tea and bring it to me

Things to please NOT do, even with good intent:

- × Reorganize a drawer or cabinet
- × Move our things to "help us find them"
- × Throw out anything (even mail)
- × Bathe or change the baby unless we ask
- × Take photos of us or the baby without asking

Thank you for being here.

The list is intentionally specific. "Help out" is a wish. "Empty the dishwasher" is a task. Pages with tasks get done. Pages with wishes get nodded at.

Page four, the food-drop menu

A page for the people who ask "what can I bring?" It hangs on the front of the fridge.

Things we would actually love right now:

- ☐ A roast chicken from the deli
- ☐ Soup, especially the kind from _____
- ☐ A box of clementines or apples
- ☐ A loaf of good bread + a stick of butter
- ☐ A frozen lasagna or casserole
- ☐ The muffins from _____
- ☐ Coffee from _____
- ☐ Pre-cut vegetables and hummus
- ☐ Anything in a one-handed wrapper

Things we have plenty of:

- × Cupcakes and bakery sweets
- × Flowers (we love them, we just don't have a vase)
- × Stuffed animals or hand-me-down clothes

If you'd like to drop something on the porch:

Drop times that work: _____

Text first? ☐ yes ☐ no

Best phone: _____

Update the brand-specific lines for your area. The point is to be ridiculously specific, because vague answers ("anything is fine!") result in eight quiches.

Page five, the kitchen orientation

Tape this on the inside of a kitchen cabinet door. The first person who needs to make tea or grab a paper towel will find it.

The kitchen, briefly:

Cups + mugs: _____
Glasses + water filter: _____
Plates + bowls: _____
Silverware: _____
Tea + coffee: _____
Snacks (for guests): _____
Snacks (for us): _____
Trash: _____
Trash bag refills: _____
Recycling: _____
Compost (if any): _____
Dishwasher pods: _____
Paper towels: _____
Cleaning spray: _____

Coffee maker: _____
(One line for how it works:

_____)

WiFi network: _____
WiFi password: _____

The wifi line is more useful than you would think. The number-one question a visitor wants to ask but feels weird asking is wifi.

Page six, the dog page (or no-dog page)

Skip this if you don't have a dog. Tape it inside the same cabinet if you do.

Our dog is: _____

They are: ☐ good with new people

☐ slow to warm up

☐ not great with strangers

☐ in a separate room during visits

The leash lives: _____

The poop bags are: _____

They are usually walked at:

Morning: _____

Midday: _____

Evening: _____

If you'd like to walk them, the route we usually
do is: _____

They are NOT allowed to:

☐ Jump on the baby

☐ Lick the baby's face

☐ Be in the bedroom during feeds

☐ Get scraps from the table

They love a belly rub.

For cats, same template, fewer walks. For ferrets, your call.

Page seven, the visit log

A two-page log. Anyone who comes signs and notes what they brought. So that, in week eight, when the baby is asleep and you finally have a minute, you can write three thank-you notes that are accurate.

Date / Visitor / What they brought / Note

____ / _____ / _____ / _____
____ / _____ / _____ / _____
____ / _____ / _____ / _____
____ / _____ / _____ / _____
____ / _____ / _____ / _____
____ / _____ / _____ / _____
____ / _____ / _____ / _____
____ / _____ / _____ / _____
____ / _____ / _____ / _____
____ / _____ / _____ / _____
____ / _____ / _____ / _____
____ / _____ / _____ / _____

If you write nothing else for the first six weeks, this is the page to keep up. It is also the page that becomes a small, unexpectedly moving record, six months later.

Page eight, the meal-train tracker

For people who ask if they can be on a meal train. This is the page they coordinate from. It is on the front of the fridge.

The meal train, weeks 1 through 6:

Sun ____ : _____ ☐ confirmed
Mon ____ : _____ ☐ confirmed
Tue ____ : _____ ☐ confirmed
Wed ____ : _____ ☐ confirmed
Thu ____ : _____ ☐ confirmed
Fri ____ : _____ ☐ confirmed
Sat ____ : _____ ☐ confirmed

(repeat for six weeks)

Allergies + dislikes:

Containers will be: ☐ left outside

- ☐ left in cooler on porch
- ☐ exchanged at the door

Empty containers can be:

- ☐ picked up later (we'll text)
 - ☐ kept by you (we used disposable)
 - ☐ left on the porch when you come back
-

If a friend offers to organize the meal train, hand them this page and the food-drop menu (page four). They have everything they need.

Page nine, for the partner

A short page for the non-birthing partner. The host role, in week one.

The host role, week one:

When someone arrives:

- ☐ Meet them at the door yourself.
- ☐ Take whatever food / bag they brought.
- ☐ Show them where to wash hands.
- ☐ Bring them to where she is, only if she's awake.
- ☐ Stay with them for the first few minutes.
- ☐ When the 2-hour mark approaches, you say it: "Thank you for coming, we are heading into a feed."

When someone is asking to help:

- ☐ Hand them the page-three list.
- ☐ Do not say "no, you don't have to."
- ☐ If they pick something off the list, let them do it.
- ☐ Thank them with words. They will hear it.

When she is asleep and someone arrives:

- ☐ She is asleep. Do not wake her.
- ☐ "She is asleep. Can I tell her you came by?"
- ☐ Take the food, write the visit in the log.
- ☐ Walk them out within fifteen minutes.

You are the wall the house has this week.

Thank you.

Page ten, the grandparent script

A separate page for visiting grandparents. Often the people you most want to help, also often the people who arrive with the most assumptions.

Dear _____,

Thank you for coming to help. The few things that have changed since you raised us:

1. We do not put babies to sleep on their stomachs.
Back is safest. We do not negotiate this.
2. We do not give babies water. They get fluid from milk or formula. Water can be harmful to a newborn.
3. We do not kiss the baby on the face. Not from us, not from grandparents, not from anyone. The advice on this has shifted since the eighties.
4. We will likely use a sleep sack instead of blankets. The crib is intentionally empty.
5. If you offer the baby anything from your mouth (a pre-chewed bite, a tasted spoon) please know we will gently push back. The bacteria in adult mouths is not safe for newborns.

We love that you are here. We need that you are here. We just need you to be here on our terms, even when they are different from yours.

With love,

_____ + _____

If this page is for a grandparent who is going to be hurt by it, soften the wording. The principles stay. The voice can be yours.

Page eleven, the “I cannot today” sign

A backup. For the day when the doorbell rings and the version of you who said yes yesterday is not the version of you here today.

Today is harder than I knew it would be.

I'm so glad you came. I wish I could host.

If you brought food, please leave it. I will
text you a thank-you, possibly tomorrow.

If you didn't, please come back when I have
sent a "today is okay" text. I will. I promise.

You did not do anything wrong.
Today is just harder than I knew.

With love,

_____ + _____

Slip this under the door, in the hand of the visitor, or hand it to the partner to deliver. You do not have to host through a hard day.

Page twelve, after the six weeks

A page for the moment things shift. Take down the door sign. Take down the kitchen-orientation page. Throw away the food-drop menu. Keep the visit log.

The first six weeks are behind us.

To everyone who came, who brought food, who
walked the dog, who folded the laundry,
who did not ask to hold the baby until we
offered, who texted just to say "thinking of
you, no need to reply":

Thank you.

You did not just visit a new baby.
You held a family in a hard, beautiful
stretch we will never be able to redo.

We will remember.

_____ + _____
+ _____ (the baby's name)

Save this page in the same drawer as the visit log. Pull it out at the first birthday. Read it.



From Soothemade Notes, a small apothecary of printables, planners, and cards for the unphotographed parts of new parenthood. Made slowly, in plain language.



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*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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